

Windham Town Council Regular Meeting Minutes



Hybrid Meeting- Windham Town Hall Bellingham Auditorium

Tuesday, May 21, 2024 - 7:00 PM

1. Call to Order

In attendance: Mayor Tom DeVivo; Town Council Members: Dawn Niles, Joe Pliss, Edelmiro Rios, Bill Sayers, Clinton Adams, Randall Prose, Rodney Alexander and Rose Reyes, and Ernie Eldridge and Tony Fantoli (via teleconference).

Also in attendance: Town Manager Jim Rivers

Meeting called to order at 7:00pm

2. Pledge of Allegiance

The pledge was recited.

A moment of silence was observed for Daniel Lein who passed away on May 10th, 2024.

3. Adoption of Minutes

a. Regular Meeting Minutes of May 7, 2024.

MOTION BY RODNEY ALEXANDER TO ADOPT THE MINUTES. Second by Dawn Niles.

MOTION APPROVED. All in favor, Joe Pliss and Bill Sayers abstained.

4. Staff Reports

None.

5. Presentations & Other Special Reports

None.

6. Communications

None.

7. Resignations

None.

8. Reports of Committees, Boards, and Commissions

- Dawn Niles for the Sustainable Committee. The committee is still working toward Silver on the point system, with a late August deadline. Food scrap system is beginning June 1.

9. Mayor's Report

- a. Mayor's Report- May 21, 2024
- This Monday is the Memorial Day pilgrimage beginning at 7am. The parade begins at 10am, starting at Jillson.
 - The Town Manager evaluations are coming due. It must be done by the end of June.

10. Town Manager's Report

- a. Town Manager's Report- May 21, 2024
 - b. American Rescue Plan Act Monthly Report
 - c. Housing Code and Blight Report
 - d. FY2023 Year End Budget Closeout report
- The pool at the community center: Leandra is the new aquatics supervisor. The mechanics of the pool are not working properly. The pool will be closed this week, and probably reopen next week.
 - We had a court date on the Pouia building. There was an agreement. The owner will take the building down.

NOTE: Rose Reyes joined the meeting at this point.

11. Public Comment

None

12. Town Council Comments

- Rodney Alexander: We need to look at what Hartford Healthcare is doing about the maternity ward or birthing center.
- Dawn Niles: is concerned about the closure of the walk-in clinic. The closest walk-in clinic is at UCONN. What is going on and how do we get one back? Thursday the 23rd Madeline is turning 100. Going to take her some proclamations and celebrate at 11am, the Council is invited.

- Joe Pliss: heard at the WDNA meeting the challenges of getting a business up and running. The health department is one of them. The town helps a lot, but there seems to be a disconnect with businesses. Would like for Windham to be one of the easiest towns in CT to do business.
- Rose Reyes: Windham United to Save our Healthcare will be on the radio in June, and they will be asking about the status of the Hartford Healthcare feasibility study for a birthing center . We got 146 baby bombs. The Willimantic Taxing district didn't get a chance to review the police and fire contracts, was that an oversight? A new CSO officer was approved by the Willimantic Taxing District for \$80,000 to alleviate the overtime burden? I have a connection with the New Haven director of the Fair Rent Commission. She is willing to provide us with application templates and training. Encouraged someone from the public school system to connect with Economic Development so we can work on a marketing strategy to recruit educators. Why are 480 and 560 buildings not on the blight report? She would like to see enterprise and zoning review at the Willimantic Taxing District.
- Tony Fantoli: After the Memorial Day Pilgrimage and Parade, there will be hot dogs and hamburgers at the American Legion. He would like to see more people show up and show their appreciation at the Memorial Day events.
- Ernie Eldridge: Jillson House will be named as a hospitality center for the Ride the East bike ride on June 8th.

13. Appointments

None.

14. Resolution and Ordinances

- a. Discussion and possible action to authorize the Jim Rivers, Town Manager to enter into and amend contractual instruments with the Department of Mental Health and Addiction Services of the State of Connecticut.

MOTION BY DAWN NILES TO ADD 14A TO THE AGENDA. Second by Bill Sayers.

MOTION APPROVED. All in favor, Rose Reyes abstained.

MOTION BY DAWN NILES TO APPROVE 14a. Second by Bill Sayers.

MOTION APPROVED. All in favor, but Rose Reyes abstained.

15. Old Business

None

16. New Business

- a. Discussion and possible action to adopt the approved proposed tentative Collective Bargaining Agreement between the Town of Windham and UPSEU (Union Department Heads and Professional Staff Employees).

MOTION BY DAWN NILES TO APPROVE 16a. Second by Rodney Alexander.

MOTION APPROVED. All in favor, but Tony Fantoli opposed.

- b. Discussion and possible action to adopt the approved proposed tentative Collective Bargaining Agreement between the Town of Windham and Teamsters Local 493.

MOTION BY BILL SAYERS TO APPROVE 14b. Second by Dawn Niles.

MOTION APPROVED, All in favor, but Tony Fantoli opposed.

NOTE: Clinton Adams left at this point in the meeting.

- c. Discussion and possible action to set a Public Hearing date for **Tuesday, June 4, 2024, at 6:30 pm** to hear public comment on the submission of a Neighborhood Assistance Act (NAA) Application.

MOTION TO APPROVE 14c BY BILL SAYERS. Second by Rodney Alexander.

MOTION APPROVED UNANIMOUSLY.

- d. Discussion and possible action to transfer a used ambulance to the Willimantic Police Department to be used as a utility vehicle.

MOTION BY DAWN NILES TO APPROVE 14d. Second by Joe Pliss.

MOTION APPROVED UNANIMOUSLY

- e. Discussion and possible action to establish the membership of the Fair Rent Commission by July 8th 2024.

There was much discussion concerning this application. The council will see if there are other applications from other towns that we can use to assist in putting the application together.

17. Future Agenda Items

- a. Discussion and possible action to consider Project Labor Agreement for the New Elementary School.
- b. Town Naming Ordinance
- c. Salary book that we began a year ago.
- d. Flag raising ordinance.

18. Public Comment

None.

19. Adjournment

MOTION TO ADJOURN BY BILL SAYERS.

Meeting adjourned at 8:39pm

Respectfully submitted,
Ryan Duck